

Boost Instagram engagement

There are several small steps you can take to significantly increase the traction that your posts and stories receive on the dynamic platform that Instagram is.

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INVEST IN A GOOD CAMERA

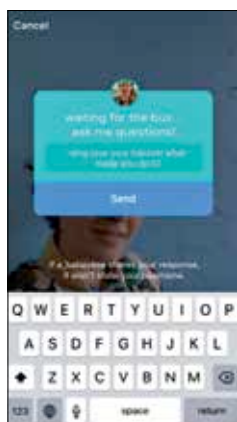
This is a no brainer. To gain good traction you should ensure that your photos are of a high quality. This means investing in a cameraphone that takes sharp images, and is good in low light settings. It is even better if you can use a dSLR, and import the images into your phone before sharing. The high end phones do produce images that are approaching the quality of dSLRs, but there is a lot you can do with lenses. There are some pretty unique legacy lenses out there that you can experiment with. It is also a good idea to acquire some knowledge of composition and lighting. It does not matter what the theme of your account is, it stands to benefit if your photography skills are constantly evolving.



TALK TO YOUR VIEWERS

One of the most important methods to boost engagement on Instagram is to encourage users to comment, and then have conversations with them. This can be done by smartly captioning a post, asking for a response from your followers. Instagram

stories have a number of features that are made just for boosting engagement. There are polls which allow your users to pick between



There are many ways that Instagram lets you talk to users

two options. Questions stickers allow followers to ask you questions, which you can respond to in a story, which is then added to a story. This option is sort of like an AMA on Instagram, allowing your followers to type in a question, which they can do as many times as they want for a single question sticker.



POST WHEN FOLLOWERS ARE ACTUALLY ACTIVE

One of the important things to do is to post while your followers and friends are active. If you post at times when it is convenient for

you, then that post may be buried when other people at your location are actually using the platform. While there are various third party trackers available for Instagram, that allow you to do more than just find out when your users are the most active, Instagram has its own analytics tools for Business accounts. If you are not comfortable using third party apps or a Business account, then you can just estimate activity by posting at different times of the day and figuring out when you get the best responses.



POST MORE PEOPLE

This is a simple enough tip that is ignored by many Instagrammers who have accounts around very particular themes. Some of the most engaged with images are posts that have people in them. If you have a highly specific instagram account, say for food blogging or architecture, it is a



Remember to post photos featuring people

good idea to find a way to incorporate people in your posts to boost followers. You can pair a post featuring a person, with one that you actually want to post. Make sure to continuously sprinkle your feed with images that contain people, and you will see that the engagement with your other posts also go up over time.



USE HASHTAGS SMARTLY

Do not flood your posts with too many hashtags. It is just a turn off. Using a bunch of really popular hashtags does not help anyway, as your post is likely to get buried considering the sheer volume of posts using the most popular hashtags. The idea is to mix a few popular hashtags, with hashtags that are particularly relevant to the content that you are posting. Hashtagify.me allows you to search for a particular hashtag, and find out its popularity, as well as other related hashtags that you could use. The related hashtags are based on posts where both the hashtags were used together.



MENTION SHARING

Mention sharing is a feature on Instagram that allows those mentioned to reshare the same story. This is beneficial for attracting and sending followers between the two accounts. If you are at an event with a friend, you can reshare a story with a mention on your own timeline, within a period of 24 hours. While resharing a mentioned story, users can modify the story in various ways. The reshared post has a button that viewers can tap, to get to the profile that